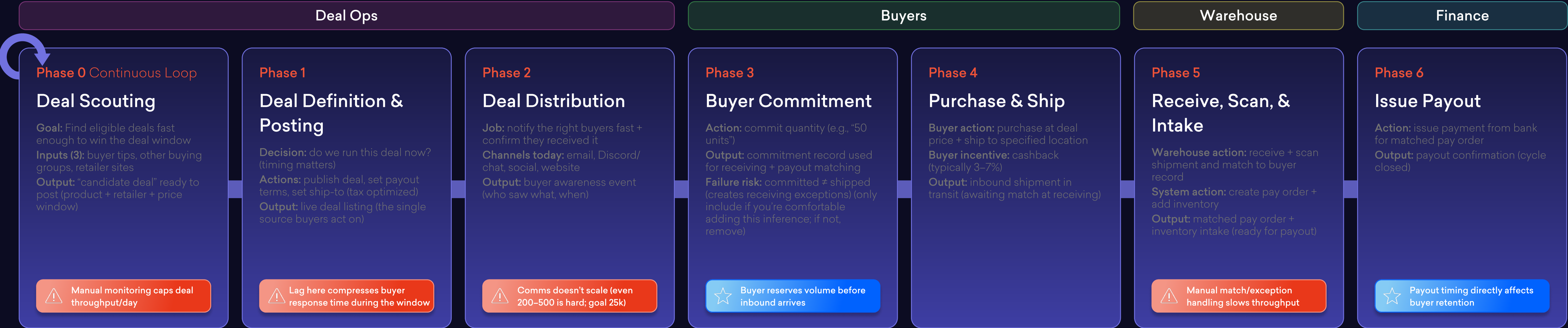


As-Is Purchasing Cycle

End-to-end process map from **deal discovery** to **payout**

**Bottleneck**
Slows cycle time or caps deal volume/day

**Control point**
Decision that gates volume, matching, or payout



Critical Bottlenecks

- Deal scouting is the throughput ceiling: manual monitoring caps deals/day
- Posting + broadcast latency loses the deal window: buyers aren't notified fast enough
- Comms doesn't scale to target buyer base: hard even at 200-500; goal is ~25k
- Too much human input across the cycle: automation is explicitly desired
- Business impact: delays = opportunity cost (lost revenue)

Optimization Opportunities

- Increase deals/day: automate scouting + normalize deals across sources
- Shrink posting time: templates + rules for payout + ship-to publishing
- Increase buyer activation rate: broadcast + acknowledgement + reach tracking
- Increase receiving throughput: automate match + exception routing at scan
- Win buyer retention: payout speed + transparency (buyers choose who pays faster/better)

Key Control Points

- Commitment recorded: reserves volume before receipt (enables matching)
- Receiving match: scan must link shipment → buyer record
- Pay order created: gates payout release
- Payout timing: affects buyer retention and competitiveness